from northern California through southern Alaska.
- There are also small areas in southern Chile, New Zealand, Australia and a few other places around the world.
- Temperate Deciduous Biome-Mediterranean climate.

36. • Wetlands are areas of marsh or peatland with water that is static or flowing, fresh, brackish or saline, including areas of marine water the depth of which at low tide does not exceed 6 m.
- Wetlands are transition zones (ecotone) between terrestrial and aquatic ecosystems.
- For example, Mangroves, lake littorals (marginal areas between highest and lowest water level of the lakes), floodplains (areas lying adjacent to the river channels beyond the natural levees and periodically flooded during high discharge in the river) and other marshy or swampy areas.
- These habitats experience periodic flooding from adjacent deepwater habitats and therefore supports plants and animals specifically adapted to such shallow flooding or waterlogging.
- Waterlogged soil adapted plant life (hydrophytes), and hydric soils (not enough O_2) are the chief characteristics of wetlands.
- Natural wetlands in India range from high altitude wetlands in the Himalayas; flood plains of the major river systems; saline and temporary wetlands of the arid and semi-arid regions; coastal wetlands such as lagoons, backwaters, estuaries, mangroves, swamps and coral reefs, and so on.
- Excessive growth of macrophytes (both submerged and free-floating) in wetlands affects the water quality adversely and interfere with the utilisation of the water body.
- Vertical mixing is thermally regulated in lakes while it is wind regulated in wetlands.

37. The Ramsar Convention works closely with six organisations known as International Organisation Partners (IOPs). These are:
1. Birdlife International
2. International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN)
3. International Water Management Institute (IWMI)
4. Wetlands International
5. World Wide Fund (WWF)
6. International Wildfowl and Wetlands Trust (WWT)